

Cricket Rules — FAQ for RAG

A compact, structured knowledge document containing 10 common cricket rules. Designed for testing PDF ingestion, chunking, retrieval, and question answering with Spring AI RAG applications.

Document purpose

This document is intentionally written in a question-and-answer format so that a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) application can retrieve individual rule sections when a user asks cricket-related questions.

Rule 1 — The Toss

Q: What happens at the start of a cricket match?

A: Before play begins, the two captains conduct a toss. The captain who wins the toss chooses whether their team will bat first or field first. The decision is made before the match begins and determines which team starts with the innings.

Rule 2 — Innings and Batting

Q: What is an innings in cricket?

A: An innings is the period during which one team bats and attempts to score runs while the other team fields. In limited-overs cricket, each team normally has one innings. In traditional Test cricket, each team can have two innings, subject to the laws and match conditions.

Rule 3 — Scoring Runs

Q: How does a batting team score runs?

A: Batters score runs by completing a run between the two sets of stumps. They may also score additional runs when the ball reaches the boundary. A boundary scored by the ball reaching or being hit over the boundary is normally worth four or six runs depending on how it reaches the boundary.

Rule 4 — The Boundary

Q: What is the difference between a four and a six?

A: A four is scored when the ball reaches the boundary after touching the ground within the field of play, without a fielder returning it before it reaches the boundary. A six is scored when the ball is struck by the batter and lands beyond the boundary without first touching the ground inside the field of play.

Rule 5 — Bowled

Q: When is a batter out bowled?

A: A batter is out bowled when a delivery from the bowler legally breaks the striker's wicket. The ball may hit the stumps directly or after touching the batter or their equipment, subject to the conditions of the law. The dismissal can occur whether or not the batter has attempted a shot.

Rule 6 — Caught

Q: When is a batter out caught?

A: A batter is out caught when a fielder catches the ball before it touches the ground after the ball has touched the striker's bat, or the hand or hands holding the bat. The catch must be completed in accordance with the laws, including control of the ball and the fielder's contact with the boundary.

Rule 7 — LBW (Leg Before Wicket)

Q: What does LBW mean and when can a batter be out LBW?

A: LBW means Leg Before Wicket. A batter may be out LBW when a delivery hits their person rather than their bat and the conditions of the law are satisfied regarding where the ball pitched, where it struck the batter, and whether it would have gone on to hit the wicket. There are important exceptions, including conditions involving the batter playing a genuine shot.

Rule 8 — No-Ball

Q: What is a no-ball?

A: A no-ball is a delivery that does not comply with one or more requirements of the laws, such as certain foot-placement or delivery restrictions. A no-ball gives the batting side an additional run and the delivery generally does not count as one of the over's six legal balls. A batter can still score runs from the delivery, and some dismissals are not permitted from a no-ball.

Rule 9 — Wide Ball

Q: What is a wide ball?

A: A wide is called when the ball passes outside the striker's normal reach and is judged not to have been sufficiently within the area in which the striker could reasonably play the ball. The batting side receives an additional run for the wide, and the delivery does not count as one of the six legal balls in the over. The exact judgment depends on the playing conditions and the striker's position.

Rule 10 — The Over

Q: How many legal balls are in an over?

A: An over normally consists of six legal deliveries bowled from one end of the pitch. No-balls and wides do not count as legal deliveries, so an over can contain more than six actual deliveries. After the over is completed, the bowling end changes and another bowler delivers the next over from the opposite end.

RAG Testing Suggestions

Example queries: What is LBW? How many balls are in an over? What happens after a no-ball? How many runs is a six worth? When is a batter out caught? What happens after the toss?

Note: This is a simplified educational FAQ, not a substitute for the complete official Laws of Cricket or competition-specific playing conditions. Some rules have detailed exceptions and variations.